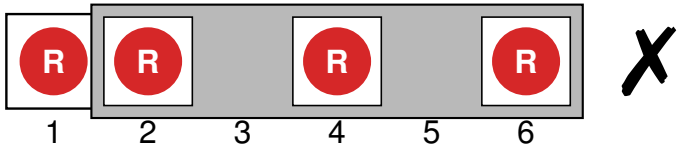
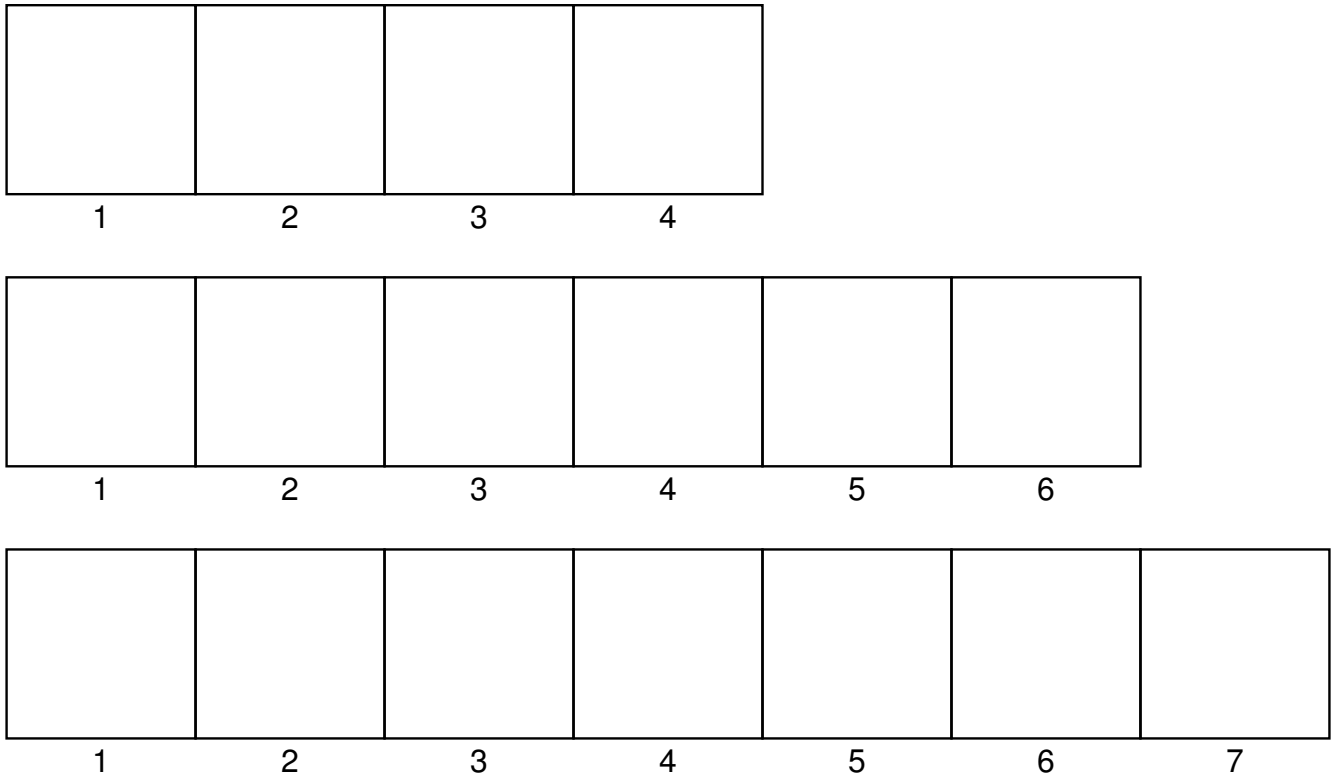
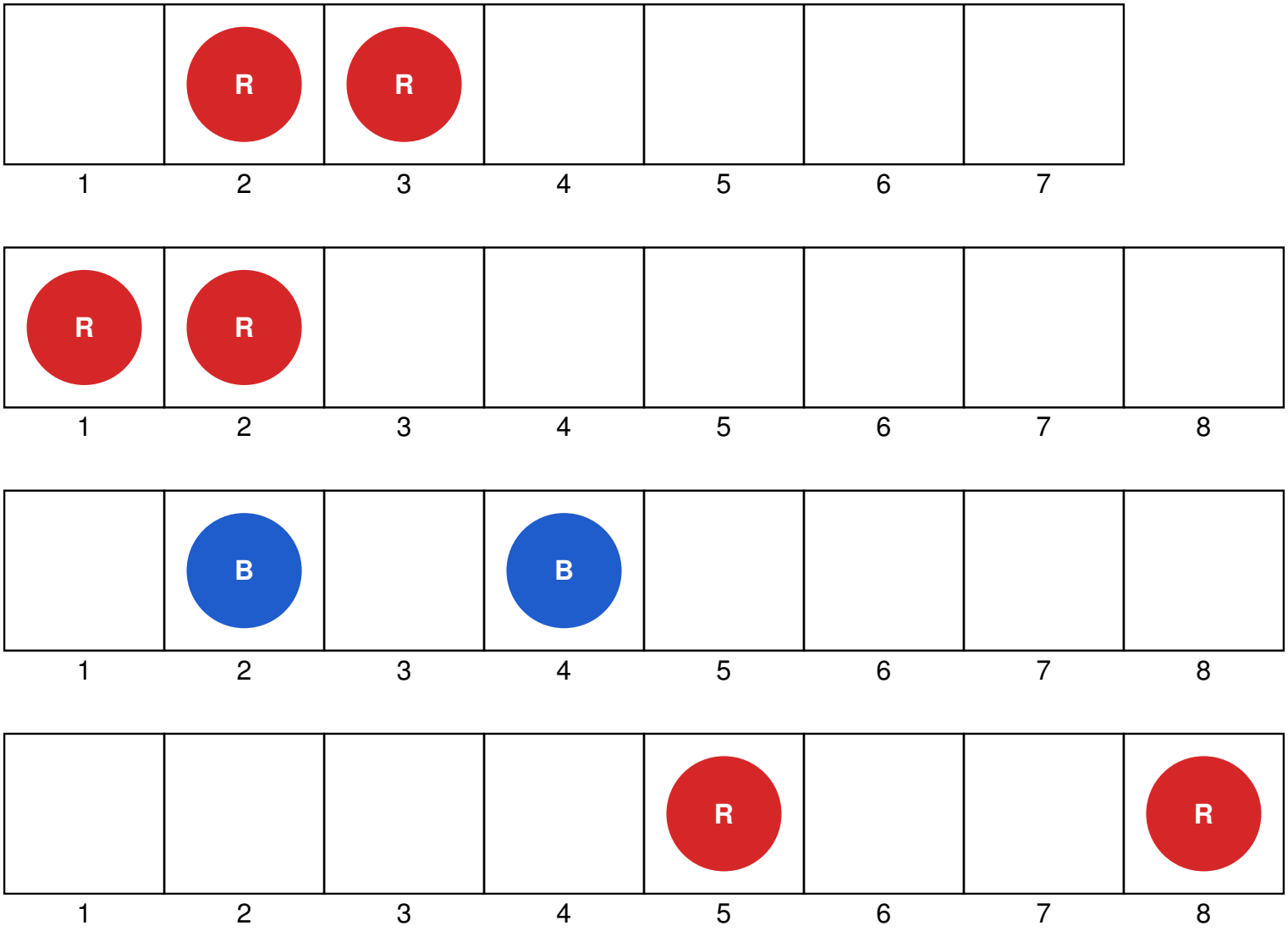
Put a red or a blue counter on every square of a strip. The strip is good if a comb never shows three counters of one color, wherever you slide it.



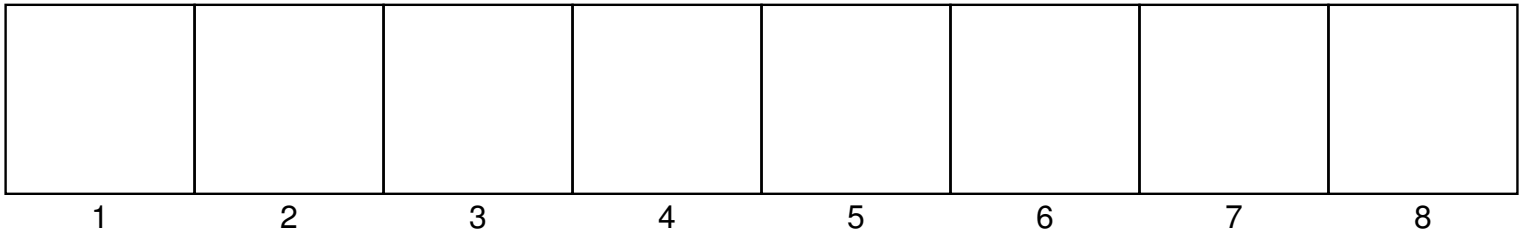
Problem 1: Make each strip good, then color it.

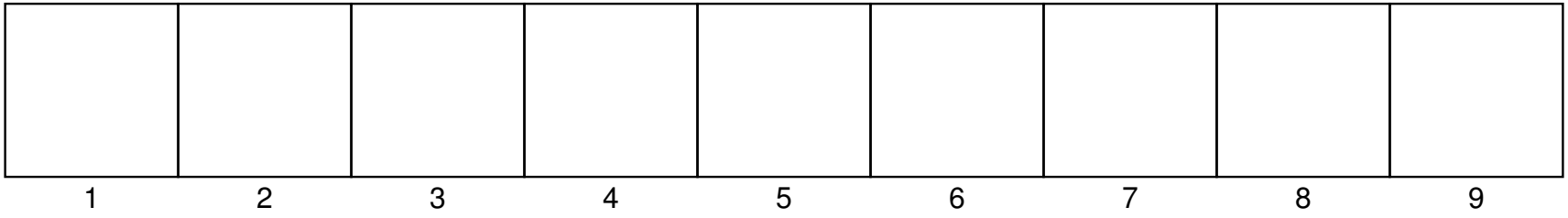


Problem 2: Finish each strip so that it is good.

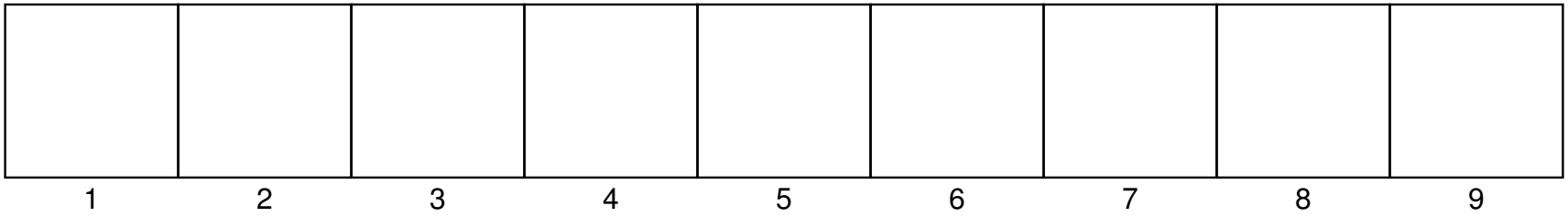


Problem 3: Make the strip of 8 squares good. Can you make the strip of 9 squares good?

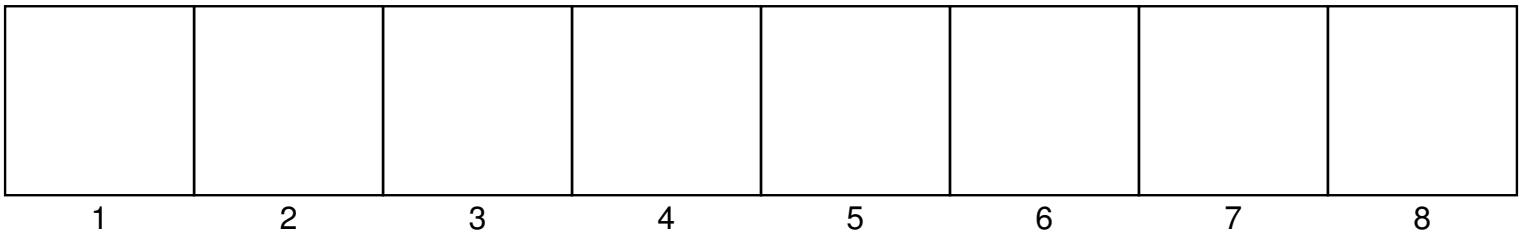




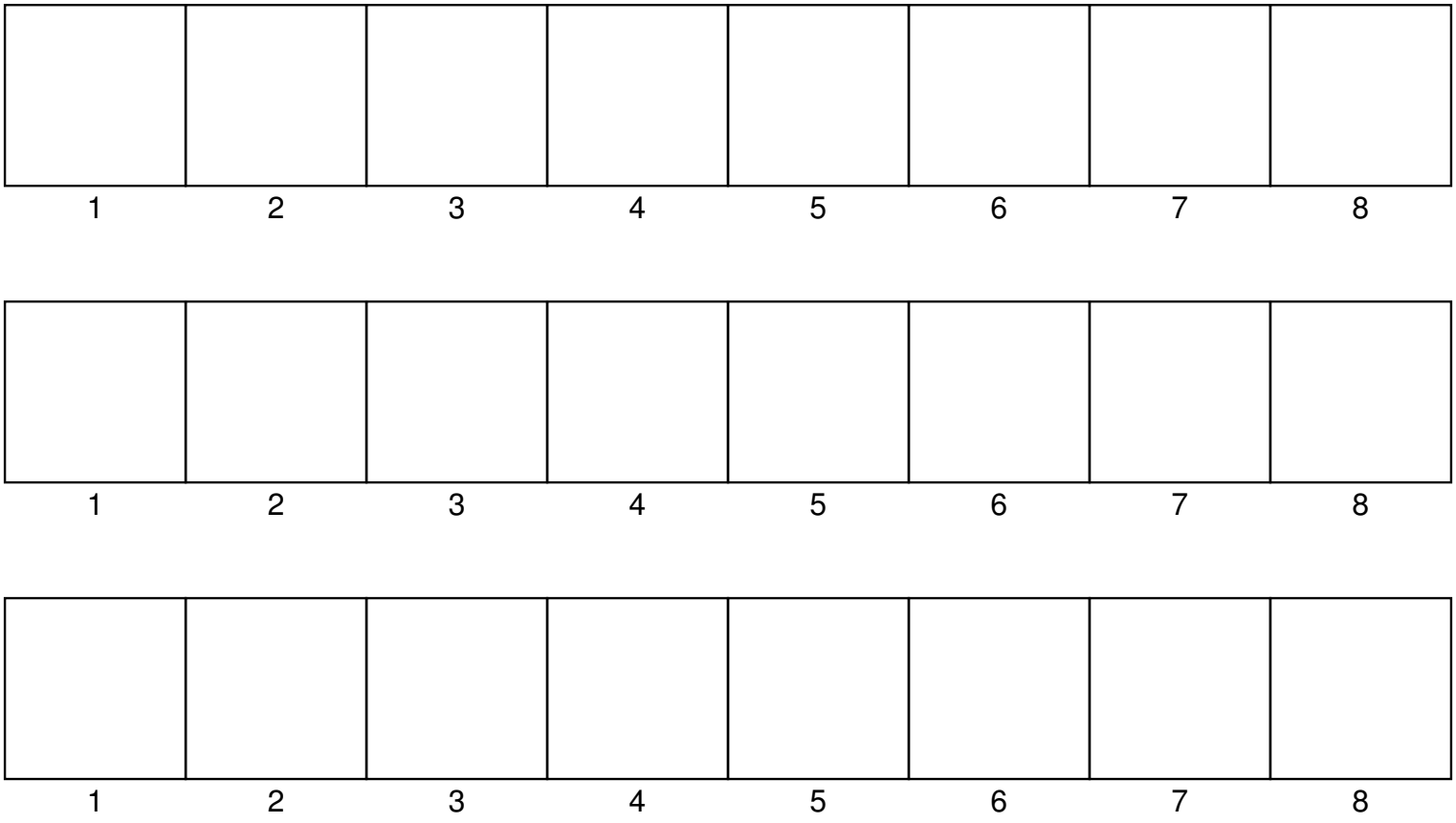
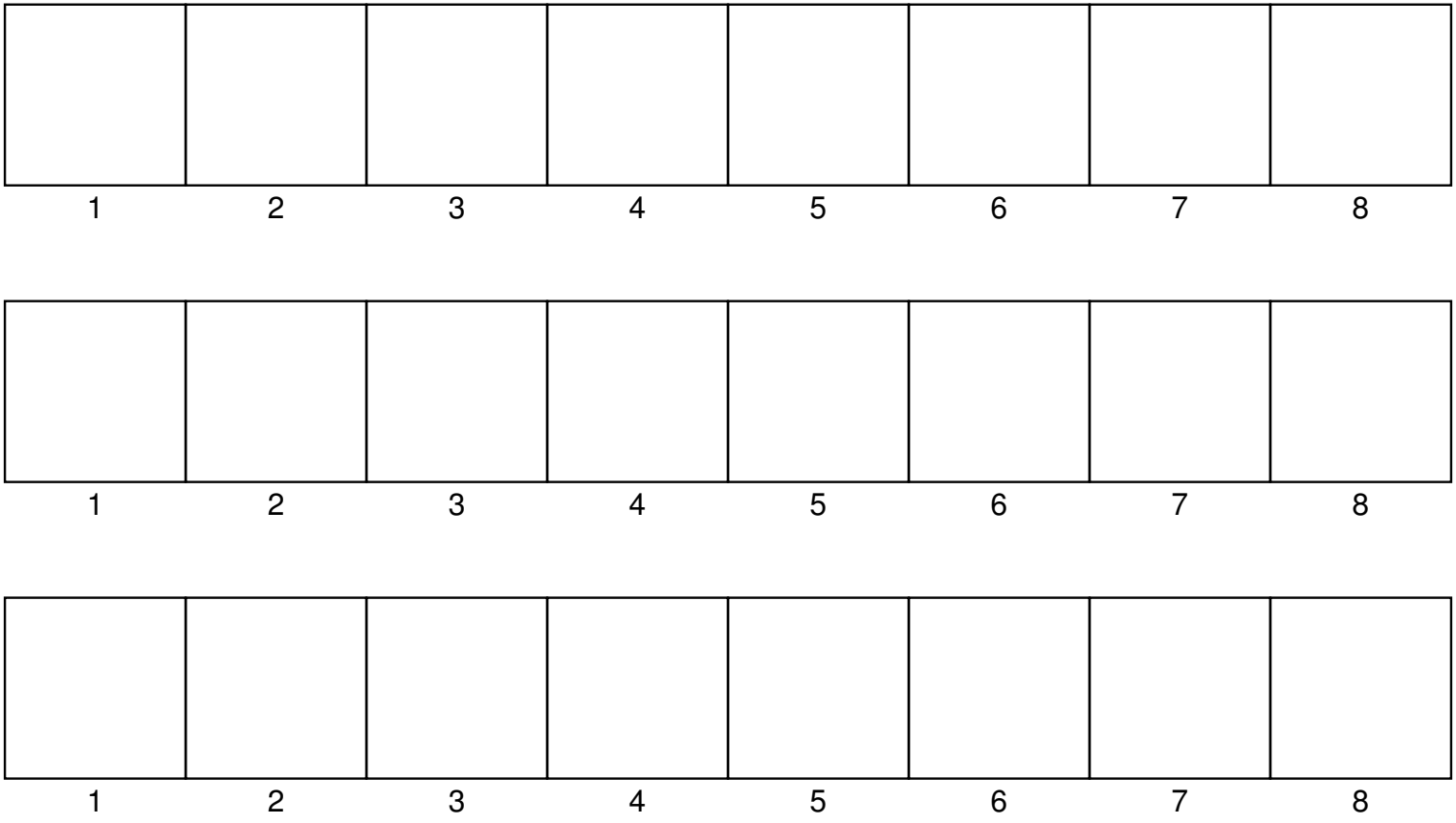
Problem 4: Play against the adult or a partner on the strip of 9 squares. Take turns putting a red or a blue counter on an empty square. Check with the combs after every turn. If a comb shows three counters of one color, the player who just moved loses.



Problem 5: Play the same game on the strip of 8 squares. Can a game end with all the squares filled and nobody losing? On the strip of 9 squares, would you rather go first or second?



Problem 6: Find every good strip of 8 squares.



More strips for Problem 6.